

Create Your Own Distro Using SUSE Studio

Creating a Linux distro is not simple; you need a large crew, a lot of resources, a lot of technical knowledge and an awful lot of time. Most Linux vendors, such as Fedora and Ubuntu, take around six months between releases. However, if you want to create your own distro quickly, and without much hassle or even without Linux expertise, SUSE Studio can help you. It's an online tool from SUSE Enterprise, which enables you to create your own customised SUSE Linux in a few hours. SUSE Linux is one of the most stable and popular Linux distros available, which makes it a good choice for us.



Before we begin, I've assumed that you have basic working knowledge with Linux, since this article is not for newbies. Also, you will need an Internet connection, and the Flash plug-in and JavaScript enabled in your Web browser, to get started.

Creating an account

Point your browser to <http://www.susestudio.com/>, find the *Sign In* or *Create Account* button. Clicking it offers options as shown in Figure 2. Choose what works best for you. After you're done, you will be taken to your home page—where your distros are listed, if you couldn't download them after creation.

Creating a new appliance

In the home page, you will find the *Create New Appliance* link (appliance refers to the Linux distro). This leads to the *Choose a base template* page (Figure 3) where you choose the foundation for your distro. There are three options: OpenSUSE 12.2, SUSE Enterprise 11 SP2, and SUSE Linux Enterprise 10 SP4, each with different flavours. I chose the first; unless you want to use your distro for an organisation or as a server, this option works well. It has four different flavours: JeOS (Just enough OS), Server (a text-only base), the GNOME desktop (base system + GNOME), and KDE 4 desktop (base system + KDE 4). Choose the flavour that suits you. These flavours are also applicable for the other two options.

I've chosen JeOS, which is a simple and minimal system with IceWM as the desktop environment. If you want to try something small, choose this. Next, select your architecture. I've chosen 32-bit; your selection may vary depending on the architecture of your target machine. Finally, you have to name your distro (this name will be shown during the boot process). Now click the *Create Appliance* button at the bottom of the page to proceed. You will be taken to the editing page, which displays details about your appliance in the upper left corner and the number of packages selected out of the total.



Figure 1: Account creation